

Skills

Head-to-Toe Assessment

Checklist

Checklist

S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
General Inspection	☐	☐	☐	
Performed an initial focused inspection.				
1. Assessed patient's mobility, posture, build, any deformities, dress, and grooming.				
2. Assessed complexion for any discoloration.				
3. Measured the patient's height and weight.				
4. Checked distance vision (CN II) with a well-lit Snellen or Sloan Chart. Test each eye individually.				
5. Took the patient's vital signs.				
Head and Face	☐	☐	☐	
Inspected skin, eyes, ears, and skull.				
1. Inspected and palpated the scalp and hair.				
2. Palpated the temporomandibular joints.				
3. Palpated the facial bones and frontal and maxillary sinuses.				
4. Tested cranial nerve VII.				
5. Tested cranial nerve V.				
Inspected the external eye structures.	☐	☐	☐	
1. Palpated the lacrimal glands.				
2. Tested near vision.				
3. Assessed pupillary light response.				
4. Assessed accommodation.				
5. Checked the corneal light reflex.				
6. Assessed extraocular movements.				
7. Tested the movement of the patient's eyes through the six cardinal points of gaze.				
8. Assessed visual fields.				
9. Tested the red reflex.				
10. Inspected the retina				
Inspected the ears; palpated the auricles.	☐	☐	☐	
1. Evaluated hearing.				
2. Inspected the external auditory canals and tympanic membranes.				
3. Performed Rinne test.				
Inspected the nose; checked nostril patency.	☐	☐	☐	
1. Inspected the nasal mucosa, septum, and turbinates.				
2. Tested sense of smell.				
Inspected the mouth and pharynx.	☐	☐	☐	

1. Inspected the lips, buccal mucosa, teeth, gums, and tongue.
2. Inspected the oropharynx.
3. Had the patient say "Ah".
4. Checked the gag reflex.
5. Checked taste response.



Neck



Inspected the neck structures.

1. Tested neck range of motion.
2. Checked shrug against resistance.
3. Palpated carotid arteries, trachea, and thyroid gland.
4. Palpated regional lymph nodes.
5. Auscultated carotid arteries and the thyroid gland.

Upper Extremities



Inspected the hands, arms, and shoulders.

1. Inspected muscle mass and strength.
2. Checked joint ranges of motion.
3. Assessed the pulses.
4. Palpated the epitrochlear nodes.

Back



Inspected the back.

1. Checked skin, shape, symmetry, and muscle development.
2. Inspected and palpated spine and scapulae; percussed the spine.
3. Percussed the costovertebral angle.

Lungs



Observed for excursion.

1. Noted respiratory characteristics.
2. Checked thoracic expansion.
3. Palpated for tactile fremitus.
4. Percussed for resonance.
5. Percussed for diaphragmatic excursion.
6. Auscultated breath sounds.

Chest, Breasts, and Precordium



Performed a general inspection.

1. Inspected skin, muscles, and respirations.
 2. Palpated the chest wall.
 3. Palpated the precordium; located the point of maximal impulse.
 4. Palpated the lymph nodes.
 5. Percussed for resonance.
 6. Auscultated for heart sounds.
 7. Inspected the breasts.
 8. Palpated the breasts in the four seated positions.
 9. Inspected the precordium.
 10. Examined jugular vein; estimated jugular-venous pressure.
 11. Palpated each breast with patient's arm above head.
 12. Palpated the chest wall.
 13. Auscultated the heart.
 14. Auscultated with the patient turned on the left side.
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Abdomen



Inspected abdominal skin.

1. Auscultated for bowel sounds.
 2. Auscultated for bruits and venous hums.
 3. Percussed all four quadrants.
 4. Estimated liver span and checked for splenic dullness.
 5. Palpated lightly, moderately, and deeply in all quadrants.
 6. Palpated for specific organs.
 7. Tested the abdominal reflexes.
 8. Assessed femoral pulses and inguinal lymph nodes.
 9. Inspected contraction of abdominal muscles.
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Lower Extremities



Inspected feet and legs.

1. Palpated temperature and texture.
 2. Tested for edema.
 3. Assessed the lower extremity pulses.
 4. Assessed toe ranges of motion.
 5. Assessed range of motion of the feet, ankles, and knees.
 6. Inspected hips; tested range of motion and strength.
 7. Assessed coordination, muscle use, and ease of movement.
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Neurologic System



Assessed sensory and motor function, coordination, position sense, reflexes, spinal motion, proprioception, cerebellar function, and balance as follows:

1. Assessed sensory function.
 2. Tested vibratory function.
 3. Assessed two-point discrimination.
 4. Tested stereognosis and graphesthesia.
 5. Tested fine motor function and coordination.
 6. Tested position sense.
 7. Tested spinal reflexes bilaterally.
 8. Inspected and palpated the spine and test spinal movements.
 9. Checked proprioception and cerebellar function.
 10. Then had the patient close their eyes and stand on each foot separately, then open their eyes and hop on each foot.
 11. Observed patient's gait.
 12. Assessed balance.
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Genitalia



Assessed *male* genitalia.

1. Inspected the external structures.
 2. Palpated the scrotal contents.
 3. Tested for inguinal and femoral hernias.
 4. Inspected the patient's sacrococcygeal and perianal areas.
 5. Obtained a rectal culture if needed.
 6. Palpated the prostate gland and seminal vesicles.
 7. Noted characteristics of stool, and tested it for occult blood if indicated.
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Assessed *female* genitalia.



1. Inspected external genitalia.
2. Palpated labia and glands.
3. Performed a speculum examination; collected specimens as needed.
4. Performed bimanual palpation.
5. Performed a rectovaginal examination.

6. Performed a rectal exam.

7. Obtained a rectal culture if needed. Noted characteristics of stool, and tested it for occult blood if indicated.

Learner: _____

Evaluator: _____

Date: _____

Signature: _____

Signature: _____